

PREFACE

ADULT PRIMARY CARE (APC) 2023

Commissioned and published by: The South African National Department of Health.

What is APC?

The Adult Primary Care (APC) clinical tool is a comprehensive approach to the primary care of the adult 18 years or older. APC has been developed using approved clinical policies and guidelines issued by the National Department of Health and is intended for use by all health care practitioners working at primary care level in South Africa as a clinical decision-making tool.

Along with guiding the delivery of sound clinical care, APC aims to uphold its key values:

- Acknowledgement of each patient's uniqueness and multiple roles within a family and community
- Respect for a patient's concerns and choices
- The development of a trusting relationship with a patient
- Communication with a patient should be effective, courteous and empathic
- The delivery of follow-up care especially for patients with chronic conditions
- Linking the patient to community-based resources and support
- Ensuring continuity of care, where possible.

A training package that consists of simulated case scenarios accompanies this tool.

APC is being implemented as part of the Integrated Clinical Services Management (ICSM), a key focus within the Ideal Clinic Realisation and Maintenance (ICRM) initiative to improve the quality of care delivered, and is complemented by the Health for All health promotion tool to promote healthy lifestyles and health education.

An APC eBook for easy electronic viewing is available for download from the Knowledge Hub.

How to use APC?

APC is designed to reflect the process of conducting a clinical consultation with an adult patient in primary care:

It is divided into three main sections:

1. Address the patient's general health
 2. Symptoms
 3. Chronic Conditions.
- In the stable patient start by addressing the patient's general health then address the patient's symptom/s and/or chronic conditions.
 - In the patient presenting with one or more symptoms, start by identifying the patient's main symptom. Use the Symptoms contents page to find the relevant symptom page in the clinical tool. Decide if the patient needs urgent attention (indicated in the red box) and if not, follow the algorithm to either a management plan or to consider a chronic condition in the chronic condition section of the clinical tool.
 - In the patient known with a chronic condition, use the Chronic Conditions contents page to find that condition in the clinical tool. Go to the colour-coded Routine Care pages for that condition to manage the patient's chronic condition using the 'Assess, Advise and Treat' framework.
 - Arrows refer you to another page in the clinical tool:
 - The return arrow (↩) indicates that you need to consult another page once you have completed the current page. We suggest you make a note of additional pages to consult.
 - The direct arrow (→) guides you to leave the current page and continue on another page.
 - The assessment tables on the Routine Care pages are arranged in 3 tones to reflect those aspects of the history, examination and investigations to consider.

- All medications have been colour coded in either **orange**, **blue** or **purple** to indicate prescriber level for that particular indication and at that dose:
 - **Orange-highlighted** medications may be prescribed by a **doctor or a nurse** according to his/her scope of practice.
 - **Purple-highlighted** medications are **doctor-initiated** medications. This means a doctor needs to start the medication and a nurse can continue it according to his/her scope of practice.
 - **Blue-highlighted** medications are **doctor-prescribed** medications. This means that these medications may only be prescribed by a doctor.
- Refer to the Health for All health promotion tool when you see the icon below.

Health for All



APC and its preceding versions have been developed, tested and refined by the Knowledge Translation Unit in consultation with the South African National Department of Health, particularly the National Essential Medicines List Committee and Clinical Programmes, and a wide range of clinicians, policy makers and end-users. For any queries contact The Knowledge Translation Unit, email ktu@uct.ac.za or visit www.knowledgetranslation.co.za

NEMLC/Affordable Medicines Directorates endorse all recommendations in APC approved through the NEMLC process as published in the STGs and EML.

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